

As we saw in chapter 2, Thomas had a harsh life growing up. His father had a drinking problem and his mother had mental-health issues, which caused him to spend most of his youth moving around from one foster home to another. He was surrounded by poverty for most of his childhood, and that experience had a huge effect on him. Even after he moved on to college and the military, he couldn't shake the deep sadness he felt when confronted with poverty and homelessness.